would also have its own flag, though this would not exclude the use of the Indian Union flag in the state. Special arrangements were laid down for the election of the head of the state, the Sadr-e-Riyasat, who would be recommended by the constituent assembly to the President of India for confirmation. Both the President of India and the Chief Justice of the Supreme Court could concern themselves with the state's affairs only in certain circumstances. The essential point, made crystal clear by Abdullah, was that in the state of Jammu and Kashmir, unlike all the other states in the Indian Union, the residuary powers mentioned in the Indian Constitution were not to be vested in the centre but in the state. All of these would be defined by the constituent assembly in due course.

Sheikh Abdullah may have been the new king of the valley, but it was soon evident that he was not very revered in either Jammu or Ladakh. As a result of this reality, Nehru was trying to figure how to best maintain the cohesion of the empire Gulab Singh built.

In 1952, despite the later annexations by the Chinese, Ladakh was the largest district in Jammu and Kashmir. It was of enormous geopolitical importance as it served as a route to Sinkiang, and was alternative to the Gilgit Agency.[24] When by the end of 1948, it had become clear that Ladakh would remain within India, there were Ladakhi leaders who advocated an independent relationship with the government in New Delhi that was not routed through the Government of Jammu and Kashmir. Thus in 1949, Chhewang Ringzin, who presided over a body calling itself the Buddhist Association of Ladakh, submitted a memo to Nehru which advocated that Ladakh be integrated with Jammu or east Punjab, in order to either become an Indian state in its own right. The memo argued that one consequence of the accession crisis of 1947 had been the annulment of the Treaty of Amritsar of 1846. Sheikh Abdullah had got Kashmir. In law and equity, Ladakh had reverted to its previous relationship with Jammu established in the 1830s. In other words, the Ladakhi people wanted to be rescued from Sheikh Abdullah. In 1952, the abbot of the Spituk Monastery, Kushok Bakula, who was widely accepted as the Ladakhi equivalent of Abdullah and was also a member of the Jammu and Kashmir Constituent Assembly,